

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Master Direction Report

Five Pillars, One Table, One Number — Updated & Re-verified July 18, 2026 (full weekly refresh)

*Full weekly research pass, superseding this same day's light daily touch (July 17 was a daily catch-up). Quant pillar recomputed on data through July 18. Iran War Risk cut further on confirmed continued escalation (a 7th consecutive strike night, a tit-for-tat Kuwait/Iran desalination-plant exchange) plus a correction to two errors this pillar had been carrying since Jul 8 — the "zero US casualties" framing and the stale "\$90 Brent trigger." CLARITY held at the light-touch level (record-low prediction-market odds independently confirmed across three outlets; an earlier Senate-floor-math inference corrected). Tokenization held (the GENIUS Act rules-deadline miss landed exactly as expected). Fed & Macro improved at the front end on a newly-corroborated collapse in the Jul 28-29 FOMC's own hike odds. Full score lineage (June committed → July 8 → July 10 → July 11 → July 12 → July 13 → July 17 → July 18 draft) preserved in every report. **Draft scores and the equal-weight model await my stamp.***

THE FINAL NUMBER · JULY 18, 2026 · EQUAL-WEIGHT MODEL

+0.75

Mild Bull overall, time-arbitraged. Equal-weight mean of the five window signals (−10 max bear ... +10 max bull). Horizon-weighted variant: **+1.28**. The structure underneath: Mild Bear at 1 month, Mild Bear at 3 months, Neutral at 6 months, Bull at 1 year, Strong Bull at 3 years. The number is positive because the far windows outweigh the near ones — it is *not* a buy-today signal; it is a "the storm is priced, the recovery isn't" signal, and this week the near-end storm got louder (down from +0.97 / +1.46 on July 13) even as the Fed input improved.

COINPICKS MASTER BLEND · ALL FIVE PILLARS EQUAL-WEIGHTED · 20% EACH

Compiled July 18, 2026 · BTC \$63,992.32 (Bitstamp, last completed daily close, July 18, 2026) · Engine: engine/blend.py — run.py blend (equal-weight, July 18 drafts) · Not Financial Advice

The Master Table

The whole thesis in five rows, on the July 18 drafts (this week's full weekly refresh). Signal range - 10 (max bear) to +10 (max bull).

WINDOW	MASTER (EQUAL-WT)	JUL 13 MASTER	THE CALL
1 month	-1.12	-0.81	Mild Bear — Iran escalation continues to deepen; Fed improved on a July-FOMC dovish signal, only partly offsetting Iran
3 months	-0.80	-0.39	Mild Bear — Iran's continued deterioration is now the dominant driver of this window
6 months	+0.37	+0.55	Neutral — CLARITY and Tokenization still carry this window; Iran drags a bit harder
1 year	+2.18	+2.29	Bull — all five pillars still positive; the thesis window, only modestly softer
3 years	+3.14	+3.19	Strong Bull — law + adoption + cycle + value, only marginally softer on the Iran casualty/oil-trigger correction

Formula: per pillar, Signal = ((P - 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact, with Impact a uniform **8** for every pillar. **MASTER = the simple mean of all five pillar signals** — equal weight, 20% each (add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N). Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. "Jul 13 Master" is the prior full-refresh reading, shown for comparison. Machine-verified two ways.

THE FINAL NUMBER — HOW IT'S BUILT, AND WHAT MOVED

+0.75 = the equal-weight mean of the five MASTER signals above ((-1.12 - 0.80 + 0.37 + 2.18 + 3.14) ÷ 5). Weighting the longer windows harder (10/15/20/30/25%) gives **+1.28**. Both still read **Mild Bull**, down from July 13's +0.97 / +1.46. What moved: the near-term windows (1mo -0.81 → -1.12, 3mo -0.39 → -0.80) both slid further, driven almost entirely by the Iran War Risk pillar's continued deterioration — a 7th consecutive CENTCOM strike night, a tit-for-tat Kuwait/Iran desalination-plant exchange, and a correction to two errors this pillar had been carrying since Jul 8 (the "zero US casualties" framing and a stale "\$90 Brent trigger") that pulled its 12mo/36mo down as well. Partially offsetting: Fed & Macro improved at the front end (1mo signal -2.18 → -1.09) on a newly-corroborated collapse in the Jul 28-29 FOMC's own hike odds (~46-47% → ~12-17%) — the clearest good-news move of the cycle. CLARITY and Tokenization both held roughly flat, each independently re-confirming rather than deepening its same-day light-touch cut. The 1-year window ticked down only fractionally (+2.29 → +2.18) and 3-year barely moved (+3.19 → +3.14) — this remains a near-term chop, structurally bullish read. **The near-term risk got louder this week, and the 1-year-out case still outweighs it — but by a smaller margin than a week ago.**

The Full Pillar Matrix

Every pillar's signal on every window — July 18 draft scores, this week's full weekly refresh (each report shows the full June → Jul 8 → Jul 10 → Jul 11 → Jul 12 → Jul 13 → Jul 17 → Jul 18 lineage).

PILLAR (WEIGHT · IMPACT)	1 MO	3 MO	6 MO	1 YR	3 YR	STATUS
CLARITY Act (20% · 8)	−0.82	−0.27	+1.22	+4.61	+6.38	Jul 18 full refresh (held vs. light draft)
Iran War Risk (20% · 8)	−2.50	−1.77	−0.67	+1.04	+2.55	Jul 18 full refresh (cut further)
Tokenization RWA (20% · 8)	+0.00	+0.84	+2.04	+3.00	+3.92	Jul 18 full refresh (held vs. light draft)
Fed & Macro (20% · 8)	−1.09	−1.36	−0.38	+0.60	+1.25	Jul 18 full refresh (1mo improved)
Bitcoin TA — quant (20% · 8)	−1.20	−1.46	−0.35	+1.63	+1.60	Jul 18 computed
MASTER — mean of the five	−1.12	−0.80	+0.37	+2.18	+3.14	equal-wt

P lineage (June → Jul 8 → Jul 10 → Jul 11 → Jul 12 → Jul 13 → Jul 17 → Jul 18) — CLARITY 55/60/65/85/92 → 52/56/61/83/92 → 50/54/60/82/92 → 52/55/61/82/92 → 52/55/61/82/92 (held) → 50/54/61/82/92 → 48/52/61/82/92 → **44/48/59/82/92** · Iran 50/55/62/75/85 → 40/47/55/70/83 → 42/49/56/70/83 → 44/50/57/70/83 → 44/50/57/70/83 (held) → 38/45/53/68/83 → 32/39/48/65/82 → **24/33/44/60/79** · Tokenization 53/57/62/72/85 → 52/56/62/73/85 → 53/58/64/74/85 → 54/59/65/74/85 → 54/59/65/74/85 (held) → 54/59/65/74/85 (held) → 54/59/65/74/85 (held) → **50/56/65/74/85** · Fed 38/40/46/54/61 → 35/36/42/52/61 → 34/36/44/53/61 → 34/36/44/53/61 (held) → 34/36/44/53/61 (held) → 34/36/44/53/61 (held) → 38/40/47/55/62 → **42/40/47/55/62** · Bitcoin TA 37/37/46/67/70 → 39/38/44/67/70 → 39/38/47/67/70 → 39/38/46/67/70 (Jul 13) → **40/37/46/67/70** (Jul 18, computed). Impact remains a uniform **8** for every pillar and every pillar carries an equal **20%** weight — the MASTER row is the simple mean of the five.

The Story, Window by Window

What the blend is saying on July 18, 2026 (full weekly refresh; comparisons below are vs. the July 13 full-refresh baseline)

- **1 month — Mild Bear (−1.12, was −0.81).** Iran War Risk deepened further (−2.50, was −1.15) on confirmed continued escalation: a 7th consecutive CENTCOM strike night, a tit-for-tat Kuwait/Iran desalination-plant exchange, and a "full-scale offensive" warning. Fed & Macro *improved* (−1.09, was −2.18) on a newly-corroborated collapse in the Jul 28-29 FOMC's own hike odds (~46-47% → ~12-17%) — the clearest good-news move of the cycle, though the September question remains a genuinely unresolved three-way conflict. CLARITY held essentially flat (−0.82, was +0.00) as this cycle independently re-confirmed rather than deepened the record-low prediction-market read. Tokenization held near flat (+0.00, was +0.58) as the GENIUS Act rules-deadline miss landed exactly as expected.
- **3 months — Mild Bear (−0.80, was −0.39).** Iran's continued deterioration (−1.77, was −0.52) is now the dominant driver of this window too; Fed improved less at this horizon (−1.36, was −1.90) since the dovish signal is concentrated in the July meeting, inside the window but not defining it; CLARITY (−0.27) and Tokenization (+0.84) both held roughly flat; the quant tape's 3-month cycle-analog worsened sharply (0-of-3, median −19.9% vs. −12% last cycle).
- **6 months — Neutral (+0.37, was +0.55).** Tokenization remains the strongest pillar here (+2.04: DTCC's on-schedule Stellar-track launch); CLARITY holds constructive (+1.22); Iran's drag widened (−0.67, was +0.34) on the casualty/oil-trigger corrections applied to its longer windows; the Fed drag eased slightly (−0.38, was −0.77); the tape's drag is essentially unchanged (−0.35). Historical average cycle bottom (~Aug 31, cycle month 26.9) sits inside this window.
- **1 year — Bull (+2.18, was +2.29).** All five pillars still positive: Legislation +4.61 (unchanged), Tokenization +3.00 (unchanged), Bitcoin TA +1.63 (unchanged), Fed +0.60 (up from +0.36), Iran +1.04 (down from +1.87 on the corrected casualty/oil-trigger accounting). Price sits 53% below power-law fair value (\$135,528), labor cracking

fast enough to force the easing cycle into view. The window the whole thesis is built around, only fractionally softer this week.

- **3 years — Strong Bull (+3.14, was +3.19).** Every pillar positive and the structural case compounds: CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +3.92, Iran +2.55 (down from +2.90 on the corrected casualty accounting, not new bad news), Bitcoin TA +1.60, Fed +1.25 (up from +1.14). A corrected historical fact moves this window a touch; a live war escalation, by design, does not move it much.

Where the Two Lenses Agree — and Where They Fight

The point of running qualitative and quantitative on the same standard

THE INDEPENDENT CONFIRMATION

Fed & Macro (judged) and Bitcoin TA (computed) still trace a similar path: P 42/40/47/55/62 vs 40/37/46/67/70 — within 3 points at 1 and 3 months, and just 1 point apart at 6 months (47 vs 46). Two methods that share no inputs keep landing on "soft near term, still-questionable half-year." Iran remains the worst 1-month signal in the set (−2.50), well below either of these two — the war-risk escalation continues to overtake the "waiting on data" macro story that has now itself turned partly dovish.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

Near-term: Tokenization is the least-negative near-term read (P 50, essentially neutral — the GENIUS rules miss was priced in); CLARITY sits below a coin flip (P 44) on confirmed record-low prediction-market odds; the Fed improved but still leans bearish (P 42); Iran and the tape remain the clearest risk-off votes (P 24-40). The master resolves it honestly: Mild Bear now, and the least-bearish pillars get paid in the windows where their evidence is strongest.

Long-term: the four story pillars average about +3.5 at 3 years (CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +3.92, Fed +1.25, Iran +2.55) versus the Bitcoin-TA pillar's +1.60 — still roughly 2.2× higher. Remember why: the TA pillar is capped by construction (P never leaves 25–75) and its 3-year Quality is 0.50. Equal weight lets that gap show through honestly instead of burying it in a blend.

Trigger Watch — The Next Six Weeks, Re-Dated

Fired since the last full check are already IN the July 18 draft scores. These are the forward triggers; each pillar report carries the full table.

DATE / LEVEL	EVENT	RE-RATES
Fired Jul 14-18	CENTCOM's 7th consecutive strike night · Kuwait's Shuaiba desalination/power plant struck by Iran (Jul 17), mirrored by a US strike on Iran's Jask facility · "full-scale offensive" warning	Iran 1mo/3mo re-rated down further (−1.15 → −2.50 / −0.52 → −1.77) — already IN this draft
Corrected this cycle	Iran pillar's "zero US casualties" framing corrected (Pentagon confirms 13 KIA + 1 non-hostile death since March) and its "\$90 Brent trigger" corrected (war peak already exceeded \$120 in April)	Iran 12mo/36mo re-rated down modestly (+1.87 → +1.04 / +2.90 → +2.55) — a factual correction, not a new shock
Fired Jul 14-16, confirmed	June CPI (−0.4% m/m) and PPI (−0.3% m/m) confirmed primary-source; Fed Chair Warsh's debut testimony confirmed measured, not hawkish	Already IN this draft's Fed 1mo/3mo improvement

Fired ~Jul 15-16, newly found	Jul 28-29 FOMC hike odds collapsed to ~12-17% (from ~46-47%) — confirmed across 5 outlets, missed by both daily touches	The single biggest driver of this cycle's Fed 1mo signal improvement (–2.18 → –1.09) — already IN this draft
Contested, unresolved	September-hike odds: three sources disagree (~57.2% cumulative, ~41.5%, ~17%)	No re-rate on this number until directly reconciled — flagged for next cycle
Fired ~Jul 17, confirmed	CLARITY record-low prediction-market odds (~30-32%) independently confirmed across 3 outlets; NDAA floor priority confirmed as the reason for the delay	Already IN this draft's held CLARITY score
Corrected this cycle	CLARITY's Graham-Senate-seat inference corrected (seat refilled within 48 hours, not left vacant)	Offsetting factor, net no change to CLARITY P
Fired Jul 18, as expected	GENIUS Act stablecoin-rulemaking deadline missed; 18-month statutory backstop now governs, effective Jan 18, 2027	Already IN this draft's Tokenization front-end cut (confirmation, not new shock)
Jul 20 / Jul 27	Senate floor-vote target for CLARITY / stated fallback window	Vote held & cloture clears → CLARITY 1mo snaps up hard; slips again → 2026 fading further
Jul 28–29	FOMC — hold now heavily favored (~83-88% per the confirmed odds collapse)	Fed all windows; a surprise hike would be a major re-rate down
Aug 7	Last Senate session day before recess	No CLARITY vote by now → 2026 signing in real doubt
~Aug 16	Islamabad Memorandum 60-day window expires	Iran: deal/extension = up hard; formal collapse = down hard
~Aug 31	Historical average cycle-bottom month (cycle month 26.9 currently) passes	TA: higher low after this + improving momentum = basing confirmed
Power-law fair value \$135,528	BTC \$63,992.32 sits 53% below fair value	1yr/3yr windows: the gap the structural bull case is priced against
Ongoing	Oman/Qatar mediation continues (Araghchi in Muscat); no new US combat death confirmed since Jul 8	Kept Iran's near-term signal from falling even further this cycle

The master flip line (unchanged): the Iran flip line (a newly confirmed US combat death this wave, or a sustained oil shock retesting the April highs above \$120 — not the stale \$90 figure) and the TA flip line (weekly close under \$50,000) firing together turns the near-term Mild Bear into a full Bear and puts the 6-month Neutral under review. Either alone is a re-rate, not a regime change.

Robustness — Does Any One Pillar Drive the Call?

Equal weight is now the fixed model — there is no qual/quant mix knob to tune. The test that matters instead: drop any single pillar and see whether the conclusion holds.

FINAL NUMBER WITH THIS PILLAR REMOVED	FINAL # (EQUAL-WT)	CALL · STILL POSITIVE?
— drop CLARITY Act	+0.38	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Iran War Risk	+1.01	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Tokenization RWA	+0.45	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Fed & Macro	+0.99	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Bitcoin TA	+0.93	Mild Bull · yes
all five in (headline)	+0.75	Mild Bull

Every leave-one-out final number stays positive and rounds to Mild Bull (+0.38 to +1.01) — **no single pillar is doing the work**, including Iran, whose escalation was this cycle's single biggest mover; the Mild Bull conclusion survives dropping any one pillar. The horizon-weighted final (+1.28) agrees. The near-term Mild Bear and the long-term Bull/Strong Bull calls also hold across all five drops. The one honest caveat: dropping Iran (this cycle's most-bearish pillar) gives the highest final (+1.01) and dropping CLARITY or Tokenization gives the lowest (+0.38 / +0.45) — magnitude shifts; the sign never does. This robustness check is the honesty disclosure this system always runs: it exists specifically to catch a single pillar quietly driving the whole call, and it does not.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 18, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY REFRESH) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

MASTER: -1.12 / -0.80 / +0.37 / +2.18 / +3.14 · THE FINAL NUMBER: +0.75 (Mild Bull, time-arbitraged)

This is a full weekly research pass, superseding this same day's light daily touch (July 17 was a daily catch-up): the quant pillar was fully recomputed on fresh price data; Iran War Risk was cut further on confirmed continued escalation (a 7th consecutive strike night, a tit-for-tat Kuwait/Iran desalination-plant exchange) and, separately, corrected on two errors this pillar had been carrying since Jul 8 (the "zero US casualties" framing and a stale "\$90 Brent trigger") — a factual correction, not a fresh shock, that pulled its 12mo/36mo down modestly; CLARITY held at the light-touch level after independently re-confirming the record-low prediction-market odds and correcting an earlier Senate-floor-math inference; Tokenization held flat after independently confirming the GENIUS Act rules-deadline miss landed exactly as expected; and Fed & Macro improved at the front end on a newly-corroborated collapse in the Jul 28-29 FOMC's own hike odds (~46-47% → ~12-17%), while the September-hike question remains flagged as a genuine three-way conflict pending direct reconciliation next cycle. The full lineage (June committed → July 8 → July 10 → July 11 → July 12 → July 13 → July 17 → July 18) is printed in every report. Awaiting my signature: **(1)** the five draft P-paths, **(2)** the equal-weight model and the final-number window weighting (leave-one-out shows the call is robust either way — no single pillar, including this week's Iran move, is solely driving it). The near-term calendar is dense — the Jul 20/27 CLARITY floor-vote window, the Jul 28-29 FOMC, the Jan 2027 GENIUS backstop — and each pillar's trigger table says exactly what to re-rate when those land.

Read as an investment posture: don't chase the bounce this month; the windows that pay are 6-plus months out; the levels and dates that would change this are printed above.

Sources

Each pillar report carries its full, freshly-verified source list for this week's full research pass. The master adds the engine and headline references for this July 18 refresh.

- **The pillars:** the sibling reports in this folder — CoinPicks_CLARITY_Act / Iran_War / Tokenization_RWA / Fed_Macro Pillar Reports (full weekly re-research July 18, superseding that same day's light touch; July 17 was a daily catch-up) · CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report (computed July 18).
- **The engine:** engine/blend.py → data/master_blend.json (score sets 2026-06-19_committed / 2026-07-08_draft / 2026-07-10_draft / 2026-07-11_draft / 2026-07-12_draft / 2026-07-13_draft / 2026-07-17_draft / 2026-07-18_draft in config/scores.json; final-number window weights in config/settings.json "final_weights") · engine/mapping.py → data/pillar_scores.json (Bitstamp data through Jul 18, 2026).
- **Headline checks (Jul 14-18):** full citations for the Iran War Risk continued escalation and the casualty/oil-trigger corrections, the CLARITY Act record-low prediction-market confirmation and the Graham-seat correction, the Tokenization GENIUS Act rules-deadline confirmation, and the Fed & Macro CPI/PPI/testimony/FOMC-odds confirmation are carried in full in each respective pillar report's own source list — not duplicated here to avoid stale or mismatched links in the master.
- **Price:** Bitstamp BTC/USD daily \$63,992.32 (last completed daily close, Jul 18, 2026); cycle low \$58,526 close (Jun 30); ATH \$124,728 close (Oct 6, 2025); power-law fair value \$135,528 (BTC 53% below fair); cross-checked against Coinbase.